Reel Script: Executive Skills

THE CUB · Saisha, Developmental Psychologist

0:00 The school bus is five minutes away.

0:02 And you've told your child to put on their shoes at least three times now.

0:05 They're still looking for their socks.

0:06 Does this sound familiar?

0:07 Hi, I'm Saisha and I'm a developmental psychologist.

0:10 Your child might know exactly what they need to do, but knowing and doing are two completely different things.

0:16 So the skills that help us plan, follow instructions, get started and avoid distractions, they're called executive skills.

0:24 You can think of them as the brain's management system.

0:26 These skills don't come fully developed. They grow gradually through childhood and adolescence.

0:31 So for some kids, especially those with ADHD or autism, it could be more difficult to use these skills consistently.

0:37 So what might look like ignoring or not listening to you might actually be a child who's struggling to organize themselves.

0:43 So what can you do?

0:44 Instead of repeating the same instructions, we can try to break down the task.

0:48 Give a single instruction at a time, or have a visual schedule that they can follow.

0:52 Keep the morning routine predictable.

0:54 Your child will begin to do things independently, without you having to remind them.

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